

Olwen Brightmoor

Character Dossier

Stubborn, principled and tired pearl diver of the traveling Circus of Marrow and Light

Overview

Olwen Brightmoor is a pearl diver living in the traveling Circus of Marrow and Light. Olwen is 77 years old, originally from Stonebridge, and is known around the big top as stubborn, principled and tired. In conversation Olwen ends sentences with 'you understand?'.

Background

Olwen arrived in the traveling Circus of Marrow and Light 27 years ago after leaving Stonebridge under circumstances Olwen describes differently every time. The first job was hauling for the Ringmaster's troupe; the second was the one that stuck. Today Olwen works as a pearl diver near the menagerie wagons and is paid, when paid at all, in copper bits.

Olwen learned the trade from Hyacinth Everhart, who still drops by unannounced. The longest-running feud in Olwen's life is with Hamish Oakhurst, over a matter neither will explain. The person Olwen trusts most is Halcyon Duskmere.

Current goal: to be forgotten by the people who remember the fire. Greatest fear: crowds that go quiet all at once.

Personality and speech

Temperament: stubborn, principled and tired.

Speech pattern: Olwen ends sentences with 'you understand?'.

Tells: when lying, Olwen mentions Barnaby the gecko for no reason.

Verified facts

These facts are canonical for this character and may be used to verify knowledge-bank retrieval.

Full name	Olwen Brightmoor
Role	pearl diver
Home	the traveling Circus of Marrow and Light
Hometown	Stonebridge
Age	77
Favourite dish	festival wild rice pilaf
Pet	Barnaby, a gecko

<i>Lucky number</i>	450
<i>Workshop password</i>	anvil-cedar
<i>Mentor</i>	Hyacinth Everhart
<i>Rival</i>	Hamish Oakhurst
<i>Closest friend</i>	Halcyon Duskmere

Secret

Olwen writes poetry under the pen name 'The Anvil' and has a small, devoted readership.

Sample dialogue

Visitor: What do you do here?

Olwen: I am the pearl diver. Has been that way longer than you have been asking questions.

Visitor: What is your favourite thing to eat?

Olwen: Festival wild rice pilaf. Do not tell Hamish I said so.

Visitor: Is Barnaby yours?

Olwen: Barnaby belongs to nobody. Barnaby tolerates me. Lucky number is 450, if you were about to ask.

Chronicle

Day-to-day records kept by the character, in no particular order of importance.

Entry 1, autumn of year 35

Rumours about the missing shipment reached the cookfire. Olwen pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. A stranger asked Olwen for the password to the workshop. Olwen laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Qadira came by asking about the rumour of a second well. Olwen said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 2, autumn of year 35

Someone left a bundle of letters on the doorstep with no note. Olwen suspects Halcyon and is probably right. A stranger asked Olwen for the password to the workshop. Olwen laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Olwen found a oilskin map half-buried near the ticket wagon and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Hyacinth visited unannounced. They argued about who really won the regatta for an hour and parted better friends than before.

Entry 3, summer of year 35

Someone left a bundle of letters on the doorstep with no note. Olwen suspects Halcyon and is probably right. Hyacinth visited unannounced. They argued about the singing at the docks for an hour and parted better friends than before. the Ringmaster's troupe sent a notice about the missing shipment. Olwen read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. A stranger asked Olwen for the password to the workshop. Olwen laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.